

complicated? Take some time to think about it, and make a list of things to avoid this time round.

Exercise: Uncover your sleep-spending habits

The second exercise I'd like you to do is to take a piece of paper and draw a vertical line down the middle. Now, on one side, I'd like you to list your income – either individual or household, however you'll be doing your budget, and on the other, your outgoings. But I *don't* want you to check your bank account or any budgeting tools that you might use – do it off the top of your head. Run the totals, and see how they balance. Take a few moments to think about how you feel about that – does it reflect what tends to happen month by month, or is there a discrepancy? Does it all seem to tally in theory but, somehow, you're left with way too much money at the end of the month in practice? Now, I want you to go through your previous month's actual income and outgoings on your banking app or on your statements, and add any extra bits in a different colour. Always taking a mindful, judgement-free approach to this practice, consider the things that you missed, and how much 'sleep-spending' you're doing – those little bills and subscriptions that you forget about, the small purchases that really add up. The purpose of this exercise is to help you to realize how connected you are to your money